

FREE CAPABILITY GUIDE

The Everyday Athlete Capability Guide

Understand your starting point. Choose one priority. Build a body that performs for life.

MOVE	ADAPT	PERFORM
with freedom	with confidence	for life

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This guide is educational fitness information, not a medical assessment, diagnosis, treatment plan, or substitute for individualized care.

Your score is a compass, not a grade

The self-check is meant to organize your attention. It is not a pass-or-fail test, and the six qualities are not truly separate. Improving one often supports several others.

6-14	REBUILDING	Choose one comfortable starting point and focus on consistency. Consider professional guidance if pain, dizziness, repeated falls, or other concerning symptoms are present.
15-21	DEVELOPING	You have a base. Build control and repeatability before adding more speed, complexity, or fatigue.
22-26	CAPABLE	Your foundation is useful. Your lowest one or two qualities are likely the best places to create a more complete athlete profile.
27-30	STRONG FOUNDATION	Keep training variety, adaptability, and real-world skill. High scores still benefit from objective testing and thoughtful progression.

USE YOUR LOWEST SCORE FIRST

Read the matching capability page. Pick one or two practices that feel safe and relevant. Repeat them two or three times per week for 14 days, then retake the self-check. If multiple qualities tie, choose the one that most affects your real life or the goal you care about most.

Movement

Movement is your ability to access useful positions and transition between them with control. Mobility matters most when you can own it and use it.

WHAT THIS MAY LOOK LIKE

- + You feel stiff despite stretching regularly.
- + Getting to the floor or rising from it feels awkward.
- + You avoid certain positions because they feel unfamiliar or restricted.

01 Controlled rotations

Slowly explore the neck, shoulders, hips, and ankles without forcing range.

02 Floor transitions

Practice moving from standing to kneeling, sitting, and back up using support as needed.

03 Loaded mobility

Use light resistance to strengthen the ranges you want to keep.

YOUR 10-MINUTE START

2 minutes controlled joint rotations; 4 minutes supported floor transitions; 3 minutes slow squat or hinge patterns; 1 minute easy breathing and reassessment.

PROGRESS WHEN

The movement stays smooth, breathing remains calm, and you can repeat it without pinching, sharp pain, or compensation.

Strength

Strength is the usable force behind lifting, carrying, pushing, pulling, bracing, and protecting your position. The goal is capacity you can apply outside the gym.

WHAT THIS MAY LOOK LIKE

- + Everyday loads feel heavier than they should.
- + You avoid carrying, climbing, or getting up without assistance.
- + Your posture or technique breaks down quickly under load.

01 Foundational patterns

Train a squat, hinge, push, pull, carry, and trunk-resistance pattern.

02 Own the position

Use pauses and controlled tempo to build confidence where you are weakest.

03 Leave a reserve

Finish most sets with one to three good repetitions still available.

YOUR 10-MINUTE START

2 rounds: 6-10 sit-to-stands or squats; 6-10 elevated push-ups; 8-12 band or cable rows; 20-40 seconds of carrying or marching. Rest as needed.

PROGRESS WHEN

You can add a small amount of load or one repetition while maintaining the same position, speed, and confidence.

Balance

Balance is an active process: your brain combines visual, vestibular, and sensory information, then organizes muscular responses to keep you oriented and stable.

WHAT THIS MAY LOOK LIKE

- + Uneven ground makes you cautious.
- + Single-leg tasks feel dramatically different side to side.
- + You rely heavily on your eyes, hands, or nearby objects for confidence.

01 Build a base

Start near a stable support and practice narrow, split, and single-leg positions.

02 Shift with control

Move your weight forward, backward, and side to side without rushing.

03 Change one input

Progress surface, head position, reach, or vision one variable at a time.

YOUR 10-MINUTE START

3 rounds near support: 20 seconds narrow stance; 5 slow weight shifts each direction; 15-20 seconds single-leg or kickstand stance per side; 3 controlled reaches per side.

PROGRESS WHEN

You can recover small errors without panic, breath-holding, or grabbing support. Do not progress several sensory challenges at once.

Coordination

Coordination is the timing and organization that lets different parts of your body work together. It improves through varied, appropriately challenging practice.

WHAT THIS MAY LOOK LIKE

- + New exercises take a long time to learn.
- + Cross-body or rhythm tasks feel unusually confusing.
- + You move well only when the environment is predictable.

01 Cross the midline

Use marching, crawling, and opposite-hand-to-knee patterns.

02 Add rhythm

Work with simple counts, claps, steps, or a steady beat.

03 Use an object

Toss, catch, bounce, or pass while maintaining posture and breathing.

YOUR 10-MINUTE START

2 minutes cross-crawl marching; 3 minutes simple step-and-clap patterns; 3 minutes ball tosses or wall catches; 2 minutes combining a lower-body pattern with an easy object task.

PROGRESS WHEN

Accuracy improves at the current speed. Increase speed only after the pattern becomes repeatable, then vary the task without turning it into chaos.

Power

Power is your ability to produce force quickly. It supports acceleration, quick reactions, catching yourself, climbing, throwing, and maintaining athletic ability as you age.

WHAT THIS MAY LOOK LIKE

- + You feel strong but slow.
- + Rapid steps, jumps, or direction changes feel unfamiliar.
- + You only train slowly, even when the load is light and the movement is safe.

01 Start with intent

Move a light load quickly while stopping well before technique changes.

02 Use low-impact options

Try fast step-ups, medicine-ball throws, rapid band work, or short accelerations.

03 Rest fully

Power is a quality practice. Use short sets and enough rest to keep speed high.

YOUR 10-MINUTE START

Warm up first. Then 4 rounds: 3-5 fast sit-to-stands or low step-ups; 3-5 light throws or fast band presses; 10 seconds quick feet; 45-75 seconds easy recovery.

PROGRESS WHEN

Each repetition stays crisp and landing or stopping mechanics remain controlled. Stop the set when speed clearly drops.

Recovery

Recovery is your ability to absorb training, return to readiness, and adapt. More work is not always better work; the right dose is one you can recover from consistently.

WHAT THIS MAY LOOK LIKE

- + Soreness or fatigue regularly disrupts the rest of your week.
- + Your performance trends down despite training harder.
- + Sleep, stress, or schedule changes are ignored when choosing training intensity.

01 Match the day

Adjust volume or complexity when sleep, stress, or readiness is clearly lower.

02 Build downshifts

Use walking, relaxed breathing, light mobility, and a consistent sleep routine.

03 Track the response

Note energy, soreness, motivation, and performance rather than judging one workout alone.

YOUR 10-MINUTE START

5 minutes easy walking; 2 minutes longer-exhale breathing; 2 minutes gentle mobility; 1 minute plan: choose tomorrow's training level based on sleep, stress, soreness, and motivation.

PROGRESS WHEN

You finish most sessions feeling trained but functional, and your normal energy and performance return before the next demanding session.

Turn one insight into evidence

Do not try to fix all six qualities at once. Build a small repeatable practice around the priority that matters most right now.

DAY	ACTION	NOTE
1	Choose one priority and complete its 10-minute start.	Record confidence and energy from 1-5.
3	Repeat the same practice with no progression.	Notice what feels easier or clearer.
5	Repeat; add only one small progression if quality is high.	Stop before fatigue changes the movement.
8	Return to the original version.	Compare control with Day 1.
10	Repeat and connect it to a regular workout or walk.	Keep the total dose easy to recover from.
12	Use one new but related variation.	Challenge adaptability, not exhaustion.
14	Retake the six-question self-check.	Choose the next priority or continue.

STOP AND SEEK APPROPRIATE CARE

Stop an activity and seek qualified medical guidance when appropriate if you experience chest pain, fainting, severe shortness of breath, sudden weakness, new neurological symptoms, sharp or worsening pain, or another concerning response. Use stable support for balance work and choose exercises that fit your current ability.

THE NEXT STEP

A self-check shows the starting point. Coaching builds the path.

ALLEIN's 12-week Founding Coaching Program is for active adults who want an individualized way to become stronger, more athletic, and more capable for the demands of real life.

- ✓ A complete starting-point assessment
- ✓ An individualized 12-week training plan
- ✓ Movement demonstrations and technique feedback
- ✓ Regular progress reviews and program adjustments
- ✓ Direct accountability and coach support
- ✓ An end-of-program reassessment and next-step plan

FIVE FOUNDING SPOTS

**\$1,200 upfront or 3
payments of \$400**

Applying is a conversation, not a commitment.

alleinfitness.com

ABOUT MICHAEL

Michael Morgan has coached general-population clients, busy parents, high school and college athletes, older adults, and individuals living with neurological conditions. His approach combines exercise science, athletic development, nervous-system-informed training, and practical coaching to help people build strength they can actually use.

ALLEIN coaching is fitness coaching and does not diagnose, treat, rehabilitate, or cure medical conditions. Results vary by individual.